

Privacy Policy

Ronin Institute for Independent Scholarship 2.0 (RIIS 2.0)

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Interim Council

Ronin Institute for Independent Scholarship 2.0 (“RIIS 2.0”, “we,” or “our”) values the privacy of its Affiliates, contributors, collaborators, and website visitors. This Privacy Policy explains what information we collect, how we use it, and your rights in relation to that information. We’ve tried to keep this policy as simple as possible, but if you have any questions about the policy, please contact us by e-mail at privacy@ronininstitute.org.

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1. Information We Collect

Personal and technical information is non-public information that personally identifies you or your technological activity. We may collect personal and technical information, including your:

a. Personal Information

- Name

- Email address
- Phone number
- Mailing address
- Academic or professional affiliations
- Donation and membership data

b. Technical Information

- IP address
- Browser type
- Pages visited
- Time spent on site
- Device information

c. Cookies and Tracking

We use cookies for analytics and functionality. Users will be presented with a cookie consent banner and given the option to accept or decline non-essential cookies in accordance with GDPR requirements.

2. How We Collect Your Information

We collect personal information when you give it to us directly. For example, we collect it when you talk to us over text, audio/video chat, or phone, or in video or in-person meetings with RIIS 2.0 personnel, when you register for an account, or when you make service requests. We may automatically collect technical information from you when you use our online services. If we associate any other information with personal information we collect from you, we will treat the combined information as personal information as described here.

3. How We Use Your Information

1. We process your personal data under the following legal bases:
 - a. **Consent** – for email communications, cookies, and voluntary participation in RIIS 2.0 activities and events.
 - b. **Contractual necessity** – to manage your membership and participation.
 - c. **Legal obligation** – for tax and recordkeeping.
 - d. **Legitimate interests** – to improve services and analyze engagement.
2. We use personal information to improve our services and operations. Your data may be used for the following purposes:
 - a. Communicating with you about events, updates, and opportunities

- b. Managing participation in programs or working groups
- c. Processing donations and issuing receipts
- d. Compiling internal reports on engagement
- e. Complying with legal obligations or enforcing policies

4. International Information Sharing and Disclosure

1. **GDPR.** RIIS 2.0 is the data controller for the purposes of the General Data Protection Regulation (EU) 2016/679 ('GDPR') for any personal data collected from individuals located in the European Union.
2. **International Transfers.** Your personal data may be transferred to and processed in countries outside the European Economic Area (EEA), including the United States. In such cases, we ensure appropriate safeguards are in place, such as Standard Contractual Clauses approved by the European Commission.
3. **Sharing and Disclosure.** We do **not sell, rent, or trade** personal information. We may share data:
 - a. With trusted service providers (e.g., email platforms, payment processors) under data protection agreements;
 - b. When required by law (e.g., court orders, legal process), or
 - c. With your explicit consent

5. Data Security

We implement administrative, technical, and physical safeguards to protect your personal information. While no system is 100% secure, we strive to use best practices, including encryption, access controls, and secure data storage. We limit our liability for third-party vendors and data security breaches.

When you share information on a RIIS 2.0 website, a collaborative workspace designated by RIIS 2.0 (e.g., Slack or Discord), or other open-ended group communication tools, Members and others may be able to see, copy, and use that information unless you have explicitly marked it as private in your account settings.

6. Your Rights

1. You have the right to:
 - a. Access your personal data
 - b. Rectify inaccuracies
 - c. Erase your data ("right to be forgotten")
 - d. Restrict or object to processing

- e. Data portability
- f. Lodge a complaint with a supervisory authority
- g. Withdraw consent at any time without affecting prior lawful processing

Where we have made privacy settings available, we will honor the choices you make about who can see your content or information, including restricting your profile visibility from search engines. Residents of the EU have the “right to be forgotten”, and we will make every attempt to comply with rules under GDPR. To make a request, contact us at **privacy@ronininstitute.org**.

We are not obligated to publish any information or content on our Website or our platforms, and can remove content with or without notice. Likewise, we have no obligation to store, maintain, or provide you a copy of any content or information that you or others provide, except to the extent required by section 6 of this agreement (“Your Rights”) or by applicable law

7. Data Retention

We retain personal data only for as long as is necessary for the purposes stated above, and in accordance with applicable law. Where no specific legal requirement applies, we will delete or anonymize personal data within 24 months of the termination of affiliation with RIIS 2.0. Donation records may be retained per IRS standards.

8. Children’s Privacy

RIIS 2.0 does not knowingly collect personal information from individuals under 18. If we discover that such information has been collected, it will be promptly deleted. If an individual under 18 has provided personal information, a parent or guardian may alert us at and we will, subject to applicable law and other provisions of this policy, use commercially reasonable efforts to delete it.

9. Third-Party Services

RIIS 2.0 may use third parties to provide content, services, or platforms. We are not responsible for their privacy policies and data security supplied by third parties. Please review those separately.

10. Updates to This Policy

We may revise this policy periodically. The effective date at the top reflects the most recent changes. Substantive changes will be communicated via email or website notice.

11. Contact

For privacy-related questions, concerns, or requests, contact: **Ronin Institute for Independent Scholarship 2.0** at privacy@ronininstitute.org

12. Council approval

Signed: 

Rami Saydjari, Secretary
Ronin Institute for Independent Scholarship 2.0
Date: 2025-09-04

Document history

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